

Bain & Company

The MBB firm closest to private equity — and the one that discloses least about itself · www.bain.com

1973

Founded

17,519

Employees (2025, GRI)

n/d

Revenue

64

Office locations

\$16B

Last disclosed (2023)

01 Overview

One of the three strategy firms, and the one with the deepest private equity franchise — which makes it the most likely of the MBB set to already be inside GIP's diligence workflows. It is also the least transparent: it stopped publishing revenue and uses at least two inconsistent headcount methodologies. Offering: Strategy, performance improvement and organisational consulting, with an unusually large private equity practice covering commercial due diligence, value creation planning and portfolio operations.	Key facts HQ: Boston, Massachusetts Ownership: Private partnership Revenue: Not currently disclosed. The last self-reported figure was \$16B in the 2023 ESG report. The \$14B (2025) figure on Wikipedia cites a Forbes profile that actually says \$7.5B — that discrepancy has been copied into several comparison articles Web: www.bain.com · LinkedIn Key people: Christophe De Vusser (Worldwide Managing Partner, CEO & Chairman of the Board) · Manny Maceda (Chair) · Orit Gadiesh (Chair Emeritus) Digital twin: No · GenAI: Advisory
--	--

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Firm disclosure	Bain stopped publishing revenue after the 2023 ESG report (\$16B, 45,100 colleagues, 68 countries, 4,100 clients). Its externally assured GRI index gives a different and more conservative headcount series: 18,385 (2022), 18,254...	A 5% headcount decline in 2024 was attributed by Bain to a hiring freeze and increased turnover	Link
Peer benchmark	MBB combined 2025 revenue is estimated at roughly \$36–40B across about 97,000 consultants, with revenue per consultant two to three times that of Big Four broad consulting.	Positions Bain as the smallest of the three by headcount	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Accenture · Aziro · Booz Allen Hamilton · Boston Consulting Group · Capgemini · Cognizant · Deloitte · DXC Technology
Where it sits: Bain's PE practice is the relevant asset for an infrastructure fund — commercial due diligence and post-close value creation are its home ground, and it is likely already engaged somewhere in the deal pipeline. On AI specifically the public record is thin next to BCG, which disclosed 25% of revenue from AI work, and McKinsey, reported at around 40% from AI and technology advisory. Bain has published no comparable figure.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.	
Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Given Bain's private equity franchise, check internally before assuming a clean slate — an existing commercial diligence relationship at deal level is plausible and would not be public.
BlackRock	None publicly disclosed.

05 Sentiment

Customer: Not assessed in this pass. Bain's client work is almost entirely confidential and it publishes few attributable case studies, so there is no public evidence base to summarise.	
What supports the story	What to pressure-test
- The deepest private equity practice of the three strategy firms — directly relevant to how GIP works - Smallest of MBB by headcount, which usually means more senior time per engagement - Revenue per consultant across MBB runs two to three times Big Four broad consulting, consistent with a premium positioning	- Discloses less than any peer in this set: no current revenue figure, and two inconsistent headcount methodologies - Widely-cited figures are unreliable — the \$14B on Wikipedia traces to a source that says \$7.5B - Headcount fell 5% in 2024 on a hiring freeze and elevated turnover, and 2025 barely recovered

Employee: Not covered in this pass. The only firm-sourced signal is the 2024 hiring freeze and elevated turnover disclosed in its own sustainability reporting.

Sources: Bain & Company public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked "est." or "not disclosed" are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.